

Yishak Baraki Desta

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SUMMARY

LLB graduate from Addis Ababa University with strong training in legal research, human rights law, and justice advocacy. Experienced in legal internships, editorial work, and legal practice, as well as growing expertise in data analysis and evidence-based problem solving. Demonstrated ability to support research, legal drafting, and program-oriented work in structured professional environments. Known for analytical thinking, clear communication, and a strong commitment to justice, accountability, and community-oriented legal practice.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Legal Intern | Link to Justice Law Office | *Addis Ababa* | October 2025 - January 2026

- Engaged in structured legal training as part of law school curriculum, working two days per week.
- Assisted lawyers in legal research, case analysis, and drafting of pleadings and legal documents.
- Conducted statutory and case-law research to support litigation and advisory work.
- Attended court proceedings and observed trial advocacy, judicial reasoning, and procedural practice.

Legal Extern | FDRE Ministry of Justice - Prosecutors Office | *Addis Ababa* | March 2024 - August 2024

- Worked closely with prosecutors on criminal case preparation and file review.
- Assisted with legal research and analysis related to criminal procedure and evidentiary issues.
- Observed court proceedings and prosecutorial decision-making processes.
- Gained practical exposure to trial strategies, courtroom ethics, and institutional legal practice.

Research and Development Intern | Boldmark Marketers S.C. | *Addis Ababa* | June 2025 - August 2025

- Contributed to strategic initiatives in the real estate consulting sector, focusing on small and mid-sized developers.
- Assisted in preparing feasibility studies, demand-supply analyses, and business model assessments.
- Supported research-driven recommendations aligned with Ethiopian legal and policy frameworks.
- Strengthened analytical, research, and professional writing skills through interdisciplinary collaboration.

Editorial Board Member | Insight Online Magazine - Young Lawyers Initiative (YLI) | *Addis Ababa* | June 2024 - June 2025

- Reviewed, edited, and evaluated legal articles prior to publication.
- Conducted legal research and fact-checking to ensure accuracy and quality of content.
- Contributed original articles addressing justice, legal education, and social issues.

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Senior Principal, Professional Development | Young Lawyers Initiative (YLI) | *Addis Ababa* | 2025 - Present

- Led professional development initiatives for law students and young lawyers.
- Coordinated trainings and mentorship-oriented activities aimed at strengthening legal skills, ethics, and professionalism.

Executive Board Member | Young Lawyers Initiative (YLI) | *Addis Ababa* | August 2024 - Present

- Contributed to strategic planning and implementation of legal education and advocacy initiatives.
- Engaged with law school clubs across Ethiopian universities to foster collaboration and institutional support.
- Participated in research, event planning, and content development addressing legal challenges.

Board Member | Rotaract Club of Solyana | *Addis Ababa* | 2023 - 2024

- Participated in community service initiatives including education programs, blood donation drives, and environmental campaigns.
- Contributed to project planning, coordination, and volunteer mobilization.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS AND ACADEMIC WORK

- Team Captain, Addis Ababa University Team, 24th John H. Jackson Moot Court Competition on WTO Law, African Regional Round, Yaounde, Cameroon, 2026; team received Best Overall Written Submissions and Best Respondent's Written Submissions.
- Completed senior thesis titled "Investment Protection vs. Regulatory Autonomy in Ethiopia's Mining Legal Framework: The Case of Critical Minerals," receiving a grade of A.

PUBLICATIONS AND RESEARCH

- Co-author, "An Analysis of Ethiopian Law Students' Engagement in International Moot Court Competitions", Young Lawyers Initiative, 2025. Published research analyzing barriers, benefits, and recommendations concerning Ethiopian law students' participation in international moot court competitions; available upon request
- Yishak Baraki Desta, "Federal Ethics Committee's Role in Ethiopian Medical Malpractice Investigations", Justice Club Legal Digest, 2024 Edition

- Yishak Baraki Desta, “*Breaking the Silence: The Critical Need for Mental Health Awareness in Law Students*”, Insight Online Magazine, Metassebia.com Link: <https://metassebia.com/insight/breaking-the-silence-the-critical-need-for-mental-health-awareness-in-law-students/>
- Yishak Baraki Desta, “*Internship Insecurities: The Struggles of Law Students in Gaining Practical Experience*”, Insight Online Magazine, Metassebia.com Link: <https://metassebia.com/insight/internship-insecurities-the-struggles-of-law-students-in-gaining-practical-experience/>
- Yishak Baraki Desta, “*Voluntarism and the Legal Profession: A Partnership for Justice*”, Insight Online Magazine, Metassebia.com Link: <https://metassebia.com/insight/voluntarism-and-the-legal-profession-a-partnership-for-justice/>

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- **Certified Data Analyst - ALX:** Training in data collection, cleaning, analysis, and visualization using Excel, SQL, and Python; experience with real-world datasets and team-based analytical projects.
- **Certified Virtual Assistant - ALX:** Training in Google Workspace, Asana, AI tools, project management, data handling, and proactive communication for remote environments.
- **Fundamentals of Capital Markets - Addis Ababa University, School of Commerce:** 50-hour program covering financial markets, investment instruments, securities regulation, and market structures.
- **Professional Foundations - ALX:** Training in leadership, teamwork, communication, and problem-solving through collaborative, real-world simulations.

SKILLS

Legal & Research: Legal research and analysis (domestic and international law); case preparation and document drafting; regulatory and compliance research.

Communication & Leadership: Editorial writing; team leadership and project management; public speaking and client consultation; community engagement and advocacy.

Analytical & Project: Feasibility studies and demand-supply analysis; business model design and strategic problem solving; data collection, survey design and report writing.

Technical: Microsoft Office Suite; Excel; introductory Python; SQL; virtual assistant tools and online research platforms.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Laws (LLB), Addis Ababa University, Addis Ababa | 06/2026

High School Diploma, Saint Joseph School, Addis Ababa | 06/2021

LANGUAGES

English - Fluent | Amharic - Native | Tigrinya - Advanced | Japanese - Beginner

PROFESSIONAL INTERESTS

Legal research; governance and institutional work; programme support; public international law; international trade and economic law; humanitarian and development work.